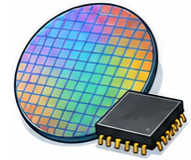


ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Semiconductor English



Conversation lab

14 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For semiconductor process engineers, yield engineers, product engineers, equipment engineers, fab supervisors, quality teams, test and packaging teams, foundry coordinators, supply planners, applications engineers, and technical program managers.

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

- 01 Wafer-start priorities
- 02 Lithography overlay trend
- 03 Etch process window
- 04 Metrology sampling change
- 05 Particle excursion
- 06 Tool matching review
- 07 Package reliability status
- 08 Tape-out readiness
- 09 Lot Hold vs Customer Expedite
- 10 Critical Dimension Drift on a Customer Call
- 11 Particle Excursion After Maintenance
- 12 Tool Matching Under Capacity Pressure
- 13 Reliability Qualification vs Early Shipment
- 14 Foundry Capacity and Tape-Out Commitment

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Wafer-start priorities

A fab planning team reviews competing lot priorities.

Roles: Production planner / Fab operations lead

Production planner: Two customer expedites need the same bottleneck tool. Which wafer starts are actually committed?

Fab operations lead: Check the confirmed allocation and downstream constraints before reprioritizing either lot.

Production planner: One request is an engineering split, not production demand.

Fab operations lead: Keep that distinction visible. Its process requirements may differ from the production flow.

Production planner: I'll compare cycle-time impact and the approved priority rules.

Fab operations lead: Bring the options to the scheduling review so the decision and affected commitments are documented.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Two customer expedites need the same bottleneck tool. Which wafer starts are actually committed?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Lithography overlay trend

Engineers investigate an overlay shift.

Roles: Lithography engineer / Process integration engineer

Lithography engineer: Overlay moved toward the control limit after the alignment update. Critical dimension remains stable.

Process integration engineer: Separate the overlay trend from the CD result. Which layers and tools are affected?

Lithography engineer: Two layers on one scanner. Repeat measurements are pending.

Process integration engineer: Review the measurement consistency and tool history under the excursion process.

Lithography engineer: I'll preserve the wafer maps and identify the affected lot interval.

Process integration engineer: We'll use the verified evidence to determine the next process-control actions through the authorized review.

Notice the professional language

critical dimension - A measured feature size on a wafer that must stay within specification for device performance and yield.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Etch process window

A module team considers a throughput improvement.

Roles: Etch engineer / Integration engineer

Etch engineer: The proposed recipe reduces cycle time, but selectivity drops at the edge of the tested window.

Integration engineer: What happens to profile and downstream margin across the relevant material stack?

Etch engineer: We don't have complete data yet. The throughput gain alone doesn't establish suitability.

Integration engineer: Then frame this as a proposal requiring further characterization and qualification.

Etch engineer: I'll prepare the split results and identify the unanswered integration questions.

Integration engineer: I'll coordinate the review before any change is applied to the production flow.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "What happens to profile and downstream margin across the relevant material stack?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Metrology sampling change

A yield review coincides with revised sampling.

Roles: Yield engineer / Metrology engineer

Yield engineer: Reported defects increased after we changed the sampling plan. Is the process getting worse?

Metrology engineer: The sampling change may affect what we detect. We need a comparable basis before drawing that conclusion.

Yield engineer: Can we compare overlapping sites and the same product mix?

Metrology engineer: Yes. I'll document the plan versions and check measurement consistency.

Yield engineer: I'll keep the apparent increase separate from a confirmed process shift in the yield report.

Metrology engineer: Then we can decide whether further investigation is needed using comparable evidence.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Reported defects increased after we changed the sampling plan. Is the process getting worse?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Particle excursion

A cleanroom team reviews an abnormal particle signal.

Roles: Contamination-control engineer / Equipment engineer

Contamination-control engineer: Particle counts rose after maintenance in this bay. We haven't established the source.

Equipment engineer: I'll provide the maintenance record and tool status. Which lots overlap the interval?

Contamination-control engineer: The traceability review is underway under the excursion process.

Equipment engineer: Keep the affected scope provisional until the records are reconciled.

Contamination-control engineer: I'll preserve the measurements and coordinate the required containment review.

Equipment engineer: I'll support the investigation and avoid treating temporal coincidence as a confirmed root cause.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "I'll provide the maintenance record and tool status. Which lots overlap the interval?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Tool matching review

A planner asks to move production to another tool.

Roles: Equipment engineer / Production planner

Equipment engineer: The alternate tool is available, but matching qualification is incomplete.

Production planner: Can it process the waiting lots if the recipe name is the same?

Equipment engineer: A matching name doesn't establish equivalent process performance. We need the required qualification evidence.

Production planner: I'll keep that capacity out of the confirmed production plan for now.

Equipment engineer: I'll identify the remaining tests and review status.

Production planner: Once the authorized qualification decision is recorded, we'll reassess the schedule and communicate the usable capacity.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Can it process the waiting lots if the recipe name is the same?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Package reliability status

A product team reviews shipment readiness.

Roles: Product engineer / Reliability engineer

Product engineer: Electrical test passed. Can we describe the samples as fully qualified?

Reliability engineer: Not yet. The planned package reliability work is still open.

Product engineer: The customer wants to know what evidence is available now.

Reliability engineer: State the completed electrical results separately from pending stress testing and qualification decisions.

Product engineer: I'll prepare a status table with the actual test conditions and limits.

Reliability engineer: I'll review the reliability wording so it doesn't imply that passing one test closes all qualification requirements.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Electrical test passed. Can we describe the samples as fully qualified?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Tape-out readiness

A design team checks a foundry submission package.

Roles: Design lead / Foundry interface engineer

Design lead: Are we ready to commit the tape-out date?

Foundry interface engineer: The design review is nearly complete, but the PDK version and signoff checklist need reconciliation.

Design lead: One block was checked against an earlier rule deck.

Foundry interface engineer: Then verify the required checks with the current approved package before declaring readiness.

Design lead: I'll identify the affected block and update the signoff status.

Foundry interface engineer: I'll confirm submission requirements and capacity arrangements separately; tape-out readiness doesn't guarantee a wafer-start date.

Notice the professional language

PDK - Process design kit; foundry-provided design rules, models, and files used to design chips for a process.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 09 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Lot Hold vs Customer Expedite

A strategic customer is waiting for units, but a wafer lot is on hold after an inline monitor showed abnormal film thickness.

Roles: Customer program manager / Process integration engineer

Customer program manager: Can we release the lot today? The customer is escalating and the ship date is already tight.

Process integration engineer: I understand the schedule pressure, but the hold code is tied to a film-thickness excursion after deposition.

Customer program manager: Is it a real excursion or just a metrology artifact?

Process integration engineer: That is exactly what we need to confirm. I want repeat metrology, chamber history, and lot genealogy before release.

Customer program manager: What is the fastest responsible option?

Process integration engineer: We can contain the affected lots, run a split on one lower-risk lot, and prepare a deviation request if quality agrees.

Customer program manager: So I should not promise shipment today.

Process integration engineer: Right. Say the lot is under controlled disposition, with an update after repeat measurement and quality review.

Notice the professional language

The learner does not say no; the learner names hold code, excursion, metrology, genealogy, containment, and disposition.

The response gives the commercial team usable customer language without pretending the risk is solved.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 10 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Critical Dimension Drift on a Customer Call

A customer quality lead challenges whether a CD trend is real before a corrective action report is due.

Roles: Customer quality lead / Lithography engineer

Customer quality lead: Your report shows CD drift, but we think the trend could be measurement noise.

Lithography engineer: That is a fair question. We are checking metrology repeatability before we call it a process shift.

Customer quality lead: What are you comparing?

Lithography engineer: The same layer across the last three lots, the reference wafer, reticle history, exposure dose, focus data, and CD-SEM repeat runs.

Customer quality lead: Can you state whether product performance is affected?

Lithography engineer: Not yet. The available electrical test results remain within their limits, but that does not resolve the CD trend. We are checking the relationship between the dimensional measurements, process-control data, and electrical results before drawing a conclusion.

Customer quality lead: When will we have a decision?

Lithography engineer: By 5 p.m. tomorrow, we will provide either a release recommendation or a containment plan with affected-lot IDs.

Notice the professional language

The learner distinguishes measurement repeatability, process shift, electrical impact, and customer disposition.

The dialogue trains a precise but cautious answer: what is known, what is being checked, and when the decision comes.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 11 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Particle Excursion After Maintenance

Production wants to restart a tool after maintenance, but defect maps show a new particle signature.

Roles: Production planner / Manufacturing quality engineer

Production planner: The tool is back up. Can we load the backlog now?

Manufacturing quality engineer: Not until we close the restart checks. The monitor wafer shows a particle signature that was not present before maintenance.

Production planner: If we wait, the area will miss the shift target.

Manufacturing quality engineer: I understand. The tradeoff is that restarting too early could contaminate multiple high-value lots.

Production planner: What do you need before release?

Manufacturing quality engineer: A clean monitor run, chamber history, maintenance notes, and a lot list for any material exposed during the suspect window.

Production planner: Can we at least run engineering material?

Manufacturing quality engineer: Possibly, if the module owner approves the route and quality agrees that the risk is contained.

Notice the professional language

The learner uses contamination-control language without blaming the maintenance team.

The practical move is to define the restart condition, not simply defend quality in general terms.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 12 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Tool Matching Under Capacity Pressure

A bottleneck tool is down, and operations wants to move production to an alternate tool that is almost matched.

Roles: Operations director / Module process owner

Operations director: We need to move all lots to Tool B. The matched-tool report looked close enough.

Module process owner: Tool B is close for monitor wafers, but product-lot data are still limited for this layer.

Operations director: How much risk are we really talking about?

Module process owner: The main risks are uniformity, selectivity, and downstream CMP margin. If those shift, yield loss may appear several steps later.

Operations director: What is your recommendation?

Module process owner: Keep product movement within the current authorized qualification status. I will propose the additional characterization and review needed before requesting any expanded release of Tool B.

Operations director: Give me language for the morning standup.

Module process owner: Say Tool B is under controlled qualification, not fully released for unrestricted product movement.

Notice the professional language

CMP - Chemical mechanical planarization; a process that smooths wafer surfaces for later manufacturing steps.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 13 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Reliability Qualification vs Early Shipment

A business unit wants to ship early units after electrical test, before reliability stress is complete.

Roles: Business unit manager / Product engineer

Business unit manager: Electrical test passed. Can we ship early samples while reliability finishes?

Product engineer: We can discuss sample release, but electrical pass is not the same as reliability qualification.

Business unit manager: The customer only needs a few units for bring-up.

Product engineer: Then we should label them clearly as engineering samples, define use limits, and avoid treating them as qualified product.

Business unit manager: What is the unresolved risk?

Product engineer: Package interaction, burn-in results, early-life failure rate, and bin stability are still open.

Business unit manager: What can I tell sales?

Product engineer: Tell them sample release may be possible with restrictions, but production shipment waits for qualification review.

Notice the professional language

The learner separates sample release, production shipment, electrical test, and reliability qualification.

This is useful for sales and business conversations where 'passed test' is often overextended.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 14 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Foundry Capacity and Tape-Out Commitment

A customer asks for a guaranteed tape-out and wafer-start date while PDK updates and foundry capacity are still moving.

Roles: Customer program manager / Foundry coordinator

Customer program manager: We need a firm wafer-start date before our executive review. Can you guarantee the slot?

Foundry coordinator: I can confirm the current allocation request, but I cannot guarantee the slot until the tape-out package and change freeze are complete.

Customer program manager: What is blocking the commitment?

Foundry coordinator: PDK version signoff, mask data checks, final DRC closure, and capacity allocation approval.

Customer program manager: That sounds like too many caveats.

Foundry coordinator: The caveats are the conditions for a reliable commitment. If any of them move, the wafer-start date can move with them.

Customer program manager: What should our executive slide say?

Foundry coordinator: Say the target slot is requested, with commitment pending PDK signoff, mask package lock, and foundry allocation confirmation.

Notice the professional language

capacity allocation - Decision process for assigning limited foundry, tool, test, or assembly capacity across products or customers.

PDK - Process design kit; foundry-provided design rules, models, and files used to design chips for a process.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Wafer Fabrication Flow and Process Integration

SHARED CASE

A new colleague confuses wafer fabrication with packaging. A process overview needs to explain where the current work takes place.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Wafer fabrication forms devices on the wafer; packaging happens later in the product flow. Our update concerns the fabrication stage. I'll show the relevant process steps before discussing the issue.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Lithography, Reticles, and Critical Dimensions

SHARED CASE

A lithography review reports a critical-dimension shift but does not identify the layer or measurement conditions.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Which layer and measurement conditions does the shift refer to? Please include the target, observed result, and reference recipe so we can discuss the same comparison.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Deposition, Etch, CMP, and Process Windows

SHARED CASE

A process change improves one measured outcome but has not been checked across the proposed operating range.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The result is encouraging at the tested settings. We have not established the wider process window. I'll distinguish the observed improvement from the conditions that still need evaluation.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Metrology, SPC, and Yield Learning

SHARED CASE

A pilot lot has 92% yield compared with 90% in a reference lot. The sample sizes and product mix differ.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

The pilot's reported yield is two percentage points higher. The lots differ in size and mix, so the comparison needs qualification. I'll show those details alongside the headline result.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Defect Density and Cleanroom Contamination

SHARED CASE

A contamination review needs the timing and location of observed particles. The current note says only "cleanroom problem."

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ...

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you provide the observation time, location, and relevant records? A precise description will help the team investigate without assuming a contamination source before reviewing the evidence.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Equipment Uptime, Recipes, and Tool Matching

SHARED CASE

Two tools run the same nominal recipe but show different measured results. A team member assumes their performance is interchangeable.

Role A | Responding professional

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Useful expressions

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Cover this until after your first attempt

The recipe name is the same, but the observed results differ. Let's compare the controlled settings and qualification evidence before describing the tools as matched for this process.

Second round

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Packaging, Test, and Reliability Qualification

SHARED CASE

A package passes one reliability test while two planned tests remain open. A customer slide calls qualification complete.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

One test is complete; two are still open. I'll report the results by test and avoid describing the overall qualification as complete until the responsible team confirms the required evidence.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Foundry, Tape-Out, PDK, and Capacity Communication

SHARED CASE

A customer requests an earlier tape-out slot. Design checks are still open, and foundry capacity is limited.

Role A | Responding professional

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Useful expressions

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Cover this until after your first attempt

We can review the earlier slot, but the open design checks and capacity need confirmation. Could we agree on a decision point that reflects both readiness and the foundry's available schedule?

Second round

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Our work is in the fab, not packaging

Fictional onboarding: a new manufacturing planner confuses wafer fabrication with packaging and asks where the process-integration team works.

01 • Manufacturing planner: Does our process-integration team attach the finished chips to their packages in this area?

02 • Process engineer: Our current work is wafer fabrication in the fab, before the packaging stage you describe.

03 • Manufacturing planner: Could you explain that distinction without assuming I know every operation in the process flow?

04 • Process engineer: Here we coordinate steps that form device structures on wafers. Packaging prepares separated dies for their intended connections.

05 • Manufacturing planner: So the wafer remains the working piece across many fabrication steps, rather than arriving already packaged.

06 • Process engineer: Yes. For this overview, follow the wafer through our documented flow before moving to downstream packaging.

07 • Manufacturing planner: Where does the node name fit? Is it the name of a packaging operation?

08 • Process engineer: No. Here it identifies the process technology offering; it doesn't describe the package assembly step.

09 • Manufacturing planner: I'll label the overview by fabrication and packaging stages instead of combining them as one activity.

10 • Process engineer: Good. Ask the downstream owner to confirm their boundary before adding packaging details to our flow.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A lot traveler is not a circuit drawing

Fictional fab induction: a planner sees a lot traveler and mistakes its operation sequence for the product's circuit layout.

01 • Production planner: This traveler has dozens of steps. Is it showing where every transistor sits on the wafer?

02 • Integration engineer: No. It records the lot's manufacturing route, while the layout describes the designed structures.

03 • Production planner: Then the process flow tells us the order of operations, not the circuit connections themselves.

04 • Integration engineer: Exactly. It helps us follow what happens to the wafer through the fab.

05 • Production planner: Can I assume every product on the same node follows this identical route?

06 • Integration engineer: Don't assume that. Check the approved route for the product and configuration you're planning.

07 • Production planner: That means a familiar node label isn't enough to choose the next operation.

08 • Integration engineer: Correct. Use the lot's controlled manufacturing information rather than filling gaps from another product.

09 • Production planner: I'll ask the route owner to explain the step labels before I summarize the schedule.

10 • Integration engineer: I'll join that discussion and distinguish the manufacturing sequence from the design information you saw earlier.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Wafer completion does not mean shipment readiness

Fictional planning meeting: a wafer lot has completed its listed fab operations, but downstream test and packaging status are unknown.

01 • Account planner: The lot has finished its fab operations. Can I tell the customer the packaged devices are ready?

02 • Manufacturing coordinator: Not from that status alone. Fab completion and packaged-product readiness are different points in the flow.

03 • Account planner: Which distinction should I explain without inventing a downstream completion date we don't have?

04 • Manufacturing coordinator: Say the wafer lot completed its listed fabrication operations; downstream test and packaging status still need confirmation.

05 • Account planner: Would describing the wafers as finished chips create the same confusion for a nontechnical customer?

06 • Manufacturing coordinator: It could. Use the actual stage name and explain what work that stage does not include.

07 • Account planner: I'll request the downstream status from its owner before making a shipment-readiness statement.

08 • Manufacturing coordinator: Please keep the product and route identifiers with that request so the correct lot is checked.

09 • Account planner: Understood. Today's update will report fab completion, not completed packaging or an approved shipment.

10 • Manufacturing coordinator: That is accurate and gives the next team a precise question they can answer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Wafer Fabrication Flow and Process Integration

A new colleague confuses wafer fabrication with packaging. A process overview needs to explain where the current work takes place.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Wafer fabrication forms devices on the wafer; packaging happens later in the product flow. Our update concerns the fabrication stage. I'll show the relevant process steps before discussing the issue.

Scenario 2 | A process-flow slide skips inspection

A fictional training slide shows deposition followed by etch. The approved route includes an inspection between them. A new planner thinks the slide authorizes skipping inspection. Explain an overview versus an operational route.

Role A: Process-integration engineer: explain the slide's limited teaching purpose.

Role B: Manufacturing planner: ask which controlled record determines the actual sequence.

Possible opening: The slide simplifies the flow for orientation; it does not replace the approved lot route.

Success checks

- Distinguish an overview from controlled manufacturing instructions.
- Avoid authorizing an operational change.
- Agree to confirm the actual route with its owner.

Add a complication: The planner says the shorter slide must be the newer process.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which layer shows the CD shift?

Fictional lithography review using the lesson case: a critical-dimension shift is reported without a layer or measurement conditions.

01 • Lithography lead: The summary reports a critical-dimension shift. Which layer and measurement conditions does that refer to?

02 • Metrology engineer: Those details aren't in the summary. I'll retrieve the measurement record before interpreting the shift.

03 • Lithography lead: Please include the sampled features and whether the measurements were taken before or after etch.

04 • Metrology engineer: Why does that stage distinction matter for a report labeled simply lithography performance?

05 • Lithography lead: Different measurement stages address different parts of the flow, so the label may overstate attribution.

06 • Metrology engineer: Understood. We also need the relevant reticle and photoresist process identifiers, not just the lot name.

07 • Lithography lead: Yes, where available in the record. Don't fill missing conditions from a previous lot.

08 • Metrology engineer: Should I hold the causal interpretation while I collect that context from the measurement owner?

09 • Lithography lead: Exactly. We can acknowledge the reported shift without claiming which operation caused it.

10 • Metrology engineer: I'll return with the identified layer, measurement stage, and any remaining gaps clearly separated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The reticle revision is missing

Fictional pattern review: two wafer images are compared, but only one image has a reticle revision recorded.

01 • Process engineer: These two images look different. Were they produced with the same reticle revision?

02 • Lithography engineer: Only the first image includes that identifier. We shouldn't assume the second used the same revision.

03 • Process engineer: Could you confirm the revision from the exposure record before we compare feature dimensions?

04 • Lithography engineer: Yes. I'll also check that the images show the same layer and comparable measurement locations.

05 • Process engineer: A colleague wants to call the difference a photoresist issue. Is there supporting evidence yet?

06 • Lithography engineer: Not yet. We first need to establish that the compared patterns and conditions are actually comparable.

07 • Process engineer: Then our immediate question is traceability, not which process parameter to change.

08 • Lithography engineer: Correct. The reticle identifier connects the observed pattern to the design information used for exposure.

09 • Process engineer: I'll label the comparison incomplete and keep both original image records for the review.

10 • Lithography engineer: I'll obtain the missing identifiers and explain which conclusions remain open after that check.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A wafer average without measurement locations

Fictional metrology discussion: a report gives one average critical dimension for a wafer but omits the measurement-site map.

01 • Integration lead: The average critical dimension is unchanged. Does that mean every measured location stayed consistent?

02 • Metrology engineer: The average alone doesn't tell us that. Could we review the site-level results and sampling map?

03 • Integration lead: The map isn't attached. Which details should I request from the measurement team first?

04 • Metrology engineer: Ask where the sites were, which features were measured, and which method produced the values.

05 • Integration lead: Should I also confirm that the reference wafer used the same measurement conditions?

06 • Metrology engineer: Yes. Otherwise similar averages may come from comparisons with different measurement boundaries.

07 • Integration lead: I won't describe the full wafer as uniform until the spatial evidence has been reviewed.

08 • Metrology engineer: Good. That preserves the average as an observation without making it answer a different question.

09 • Integration lead: I'll request the missing map and ask the owner to explain any unmatched sites.

10 • Metrology engineer: Then we can discuss the critical-dimension pattern with the context needed for a useful review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Lithography, Reticles, and Critical Dimensions

A lithography review reports a critical-dimension shift but does not identify the layer or measurement conditions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Which layer and measurement conditions does the shift refer to? Please include the target, observed result, and reference recipe so we can discuss the same comparison.

Scenario 2 | Nanometers or a relative percentage?

A fictional lithography slide labels a shift as 3 without a unit. The underlying measurement table has not been retrieved. Clarify whether this is a dimensional value, percentage, or other measure before interpreting it.

Role A: Process reviewer: request the unit, reference, layer, and measurement stage.

Role B: Report author: acknowledge the missing label and commit to checking the source.

Possible opening: Could you clarify what the value three measures and which reference it is compared with?

Success checks

- Do not infer the missing unit.
- Request the measurement context and reference.
- Keep significance and cause unconfirmed until the source is checked.

Add a complication: A manager asks you to assume nanometers because the meeting concerns critical dimensions.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A better center point is not a process window

Fictional process review using the lesson case: a change improves one measured outcome at one setting but has not been checked across the proposed range.

01 • Process engineer: The changed setting improved our measured result. Can we say the process window is wider?

02 • Integration lead: We only tested one setting. A wider operating range hasn't been demonstrated by that observation.

03 • Process engineer: So the improvement is real for the measured case, but the range claim is still an assumption.

04 • Integration lead: Exactly. We need evidence across the proposed conditions before describing an expanded process window.

05 • Process engineer: Should we also check effects on downstream etch instead of looking only at deposition output?

06 • Integration lead: Yes, through the approved evaluation plan. Improving one stage doesn't establish the integrated outcome.

07 • Process engineer: I'll present the measured result separately from the hypothesis about a broader operating range.

08 • Integration lead: Please retain the tested conditions and identify the untested range explicitly in the review.

09 • Process engineer: I'll ask the evaluation owner which additional comparisons are needed before recommending any process change.

10 • Integration lead: Good. Today's conclusion can remain useful without turning one point into a qualified window.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A smoother surface with an open thickness question

Fictional CMP evaluation: one polished sample shows lower measured roughness, but remaining-film thickness has not been assessed.

01 • CMP engineer: The sample has lower measured roughness after polishing. I'd like to call the new condition better.

02 • Integration engineer: Better on roughness, yes. Have we assessed the remaining film thickness under that condition?

03 • CMP engineer: Not yet. Chemical mechanical polishing, or CMP, was evaluated only for this surface measurement so far.

04 • Integration engineer: Then the integrated result is incomplete. A surface improvement doesn't answer the open thickness question.

05 • CMP engineer: Should I describe thickness loss as a confirmed problem in the review to emphasize the risk?

06 • Integration engineer: No. It is unmeasured here, not established as excessive. Keep observation and concern distinct.

07 • CMP engineer: I'll request thickness evidence from the evaluation owner before proposing a wider process window.

08 • Integration engineer: Please include comparable conditions so the new measurement can be interpreted alongside the roughness result.

09 • CMP engineer: The slide will say improved measured roughness in one sample, with thickness assessment pending.

10 • Integration engineer: That gives us a bounded finding and a clear next question for the process review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An etch result after two changes

Fictional engineering trial: both the incoming deposited film and the etch condition changed; a profile measurement improved.

01 • Etch engineer: The profile improved in this trial. I think the changed etch condition caused the improvement.

02 • Deposition engineer: The incoming film also changed, so this trial doesn't isolate the etch condition's contribution.

03 • Etch engineer: You're right. We altered two parts of the process flow before measuring the result.

04 • Deposition engineer: We can report the combined trial outcome while keeping the individual explanations as hypotheses.

05 • Etch engineer: Would repeating the same combined condition establish which of the two changes mattered?

06 • Deposition engineer: It could test repeatability of the combination, but it wouldn't separate the two effects by itself.

07 • Etch engineer: Then let's ask the evaluation owner for a comparison that addresses those effects under controlled conditions.

08 • Deposition engineer: Agreed. We should preserve the trial records and the incoming-film description for that planning discussion.

09 • Etch engineer: I'll remove the single-cause claim and avoid saying the process window has been qualified.

10 • Deposition engineer: Good. The review can recognize progress while clearly stating what the evidence does not yet isolate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Deposition, Etch, CMP, and Process Windows

A process change improves one measured outcome but has not been checked across the proposed operating range.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The result is encouraging at the tested settings. We have not established the wider process window. I'll distinguish the observed improvement from the conditions that still need evaluation.

Scenario 2 | The edge sites are still unmeasured

A fictional deposition trial meets its target at center-wafer sites. Edge sites were not measured, and no full-wafer claim has been assessed. Discuss the result and a request for further evidence without changing a recipe.

Role A: Deposition engineer: state that measured center sites meet the target and identify the unmeasured edge sites.

Role B: Integration reviewer: ask what remains unknown about spatial performance.

Possible opening: The measured center sites meet the target, but the edge sites are still unmeasured.

Success checks

- Limit the finding to measured sites.
- Distinguish missing evidence from a failed result.
- Agree an evaluation question for the responsible owner.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to title the slide Full-wafer improvement confirmed.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ninety-two percent is not yet a matched improvement

Fictional yield review using the lesson case: a pilot lot has 92% yield versus 90% for a reference lot; sample sizes and product mix differ.

01 • Yield analyst: The pilot yield is ninety-two percent, compared with ninety percent in the reference lot.

02 • Integration manager: Can I report a confirmed process improvement in the executive summary this afternoon?

03 • Yield analyst: Not yet. Sample sizes and product mix differ, so the current comparison isn't matched.

04 • Integration manager: What work is complete, and what still prevents a clear statement about improvement?

05 • Yield analyst: The reported lot yields are available. A like-for-like comparison and uncertainty review remain pending.

06 • Integration manager: Please don't bury the good result, but show why the two-point difference needs interpretation.

07 • Yield analyst: I'll display both rates with their denominators and product breakdown once those records are verified.

08 • Integration manager: Does the metrology review offer an independent explanation for the difference at this stage?

09 • Yield analyst: No confirmed explanation yet. I'll keep measurement findings separate from the yield attribution.

10 • Integration manager: Good. Report the observed rates and the next analysis step, not an improvement already established.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An SPC signal awaits investigation

Fictional monitoring handoff: an SPC chart flags one point for review; the measurement record is available, but the process investigation has not begun.

01 • Metrology engineer: The statistical process control chart flagged one point, and the underlying measurement record is available.

02 • Shift manager: Does that establish a product failure, or does it identify something that needs investigation?

03 • Metrology engineer: It identifies a signal under this chart's configured rules. Product disposition hasn't been established here.

04 • Shift manager: Then which parts of the excursion review are complete and which remain pending?

05 • Metrology engineer: The signal was captured. Verification of measurement context and the process review are still pending.

06 • Shift manager: Please hand those open items to their owners rather than describing the entire review as complete.

07 • Metrology engineer: I'll attach the chart version and measurement context through the established quality workflow.

08 • Shift manager: Can you state the operational impact without inventing a hold instruction or assuming release authority?

09 • Metrology engineer: I'll say disposition awaits the responsible team's review and refer any operational decision to them.

10 • Shift manager: That is the right boundary. Keep the observed signal visible while the investigation proceeds.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A measurement rerun is complete, the yield analysis is not

Fictional yield-learning project: a corrected metrology report is ready, but its relationship to final test yield has not been analyzed.

01 • Program lead: The metrology rerun is finished. Can we mark the yield-learning action complete as well?

02 • Yield engineer: Only the measurement step is complete. We haven't analyzed its relationship to final test yield.

03 • Program lead: I thought collecting corrected measurements automatically resolved the explanation for the yield change.

04 • Yield engineer: It improves the evidence, but the interpretation still requires matched lot and test information.

05 • Program lead: Which dependency should the status report show so the remaining work has a clear owner?

06 • Yield engineer: The test-data owner needs to confirm the corresponding lot records before we perform that comparison.

07 • Program lead: Does that mean the corrected metrology results should stay hidden until the whole analysis finishes?

08 • Yield engineer: No. Show them as completed evidence, with the yield relationship explicitly unassessed.

09 • Program lead: I'll separate measurement completion from analysis completion and request the matched records at the next checkpoint.

10 • Yield engineer: I'll confirm the scope of the comparison once the records arrive and keep unresolved attribution visible.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Metrology, SPC, and Yield Learning

A pilot lot has 92% yield compared with 90% in a reference lot. The sample sizes and product mix differ.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The pilot's reported yield is two percentage points higher. The lots differ in size and mix, so the comparison needs qualification. I'll show those details alongside the headline result.

Scenario 2 | The denominator excludes untested dies

A fictional pilot report lists 96 passes out of 100 tested dies. Twenty additional dies have not been tested. A colleague calls the whole group 96% passing. Explain the completed test result and pending coverage.

Role A: Yield analyst: state the tested denominator and the untested count.

Role B: Program manager: ask what can be said about all 120 dies.

Possible opening: The ninety-six percent rate applies to the hundred tested dies, not all one hundred twenty.

Success checks

- Preserve the tested denominator.
- Distinguish untested from passing.
- Agree a follow-up for missing test coverage.

Add a complication: The manager asks to count untested dies as passes because no failures were recorded.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Replace cleanroom problem with location and time

Fictional contamination review using the lesson case: a note says only cleanroom problem and lacks particle timing and location.

01 • Contamination engineer: The note says cleanroom problem. Could you provide the time and location of the observed particles?

02 • Shift coordinator: I can ask the reporting technician, but the note doesn't identify a tool or sampling point.

03 • Contamination engineer: Please request those details and the observation method before our review, or identify what cannot be recovered.

04 • Shift coordinator: Should I also ask the technician to name the contamination source they suspect?

05 • Contamination engineer: They can label a hypothesis, but the immediate priority is the observed evidence, not a guessed source.

06 • Shift coordinator: Understood. Would defect density help, or do we need the inspected area to interpret it?

07 • Contamination engineer: We need the relevant count and area information rather than an unexplained density value.

08 • Shift coordinator: I'll request the original record through our contamination-control channel and preserve the observation wording.

09 • Contamination engineer: Thank you. Avoid circulating unsupported blame about a person, tool, or cleaning activity.

10 • Shift coordinator: I'll return with verified details and explicit gaps so the review can decide its next steps.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

More particles on a larger inspected area

Fictional inspection comparison: one record lists 12 particles over twice the inspected area of a record listing 8; methods have not been compared.

01 • Quality coordinator: The new inspection found twelve particles instead of eight. Can we call contamination worse?

02 • Defect engineer: The inspected area doubled, so raw counts alone don't establish that comparison. Please obtain both area records.

03 • Quality coordinator: Should I calculate defect density immediately and use that as the final conclusion?

04 • Defect engineer: First confirm comparable methods and what each count includes. A ratio doesn't repair unmatched definitions.

05 • Quality coordinator: What precise request should I send the inspection owner for our afternoon review?

06 • Defect engineer: Ask for inspected area, counting criteria, method, and sampling locations for both records.

07 • Quality coordinator: I'll also ask which entries are verified so we don't quietly fill missing information ourselves.

08 • Defect engineer: Good. Keep the particle counts visible but label the comparative interpretation as pending.

09 • Quality coordinator: Can we agree to review the source records before discussing a contamination-control response?

10 • Defect engineer: Yes. The responsible review team needs comparable evidence before drawing conclusions or proposing operational changes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A photo without an observation timestamp

Fictional cleanroom review: a particle image is attached to an issue, but the upload date is the only recorded time.

01 • Process coordinator: The particle image was uploaded at nine. Can I say the observation occurred then?

02 • Contamination reviewer: No. Upload time and observation time can differ. Please request the original capture record.

03 • Process coordinator: The image also lacks a sampling-location label. Should I infer the location from the issue owner?

04 • Contamination reviewer: Please don't. Ask the reporting owner to identify the actual location and any missing metadata.

05 • Process coordinator: I'll request capture time, location, and method before tomorrow's contamination review, with gaps explicitly reported.

06 • Contamination reviewer: That gives the request a clear purpose and avoids attaching false precision to the timeline.

07 • Process coordinator: Should we delay every discussion until the metadata is complete, even though the image exists?

08 • Contamination reviewer: We can discuss the documented observation and missing context, but not attribute it to a particular event.

09 • Process coordinator: I'll preserve the image and distinguish upload time from the unconfirmed observation time in the handoff.

10 • Contamination reviewer: Good. That helps the review team assess the evidence without an invented sequence of events.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Defect Density and Cleanroom Contamination

A contamination review needs the timing and location of observed particles. The current note says only "cleanroom problem."

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you provide the observation time, location, and relevant records? A precise description will help the team investigate without assuming a contamination source before reviewing the evidence.

Scenario 2 | Before or after the cleaning event?

A fictional particle report and a cleaning record share a date, but neither includes a usable time. No causal link has been established. Request evidence that could clarify the sequence without issuing contamination-control instructions.

Role A: Contamination reviewer: ask for original observation and cleaning records.

Role B: Shift coordinator: identify the missing sequence and contact the record owners.

Possible opening: The records share a date, but we cannot yet tell whether the observation preceded the cleaning.

Success checks

- Avoid inferring sequence from a shared date.
- Request specific original timing evidence.
- Keep source attribution unconfirmed.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to describe cleaning as the confirmed contamination source.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The same recipe name does not establish tool matching

Fictional equipment comparison using the lesson case: two tools run the same nominal recipe but produce different measured results.

01 • Production planner: Both tools run the same nominal recipe. Can we treat their output as interchangeable?

02 • Equipment engineer: The measured results differ, so the shared recipe name doesn't establish tool matching.

03 • Production planner: What should we compare before choosing which tool to allocate to the next evaluation?

04 • Equipment engineer: Use comparable product, measurement conditions, configuration records, and relevant maintenance history for both tools.

05 • Production planner: Tool A has better uptime. Would that alone make it the stronger option?

06 • Equipment engineer: It helps availability, but uptime doesn't answer whether the process results meet the same requirements.

07 • Production planner: So the tradeoff may involve availability and demonstrated process performance, not a single winner.

08 • Equipment engineer: Exactly. We should also distinguish measured differences from any unverified explanation about their cause.

09 • Production planner: I'll request a like-for-like comparison and avoid assigning work based only on the recipe label.

10 • Equipment engineer: I'll bring the tool-matching evidence and open questions to the responsible allocation review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Uptime measured with different exclusions

Fictional equipment report: one tool's uptime excludes preventive-maintenance hours, while another report includes those hours in its denominator.

01 • Operations manager: Tool A's uptime is higher than tool B's. Should we prioritize A for capacity planning?

02 • Equipment analyst: Their reports treat preventive maintenance differently, so the percentages aren't directly comparable yet.

03 • Operations manager: Can you explain the mismatch without getting lost in the dashboard calculation details?

04 • Equipment analyst: One percentage excludes planned maintenance time; the other includes it in the time being measured.

05 • Operations manager: Then we need the same measurement boundary before ranking their availability from those figures.

06 • Equipment analyst: Yes. I'll recalculate using an agreed definition and show planned maintenance separately.

07 • Operations manager: Will that establish which tool produces better process results or meets matching requirements?

08 • Equipment analyst: No. Availability and process performance are separate criteria, and both matter to the allocation discussion.

09 • Operations manager: Please bring the aligned uptime view together with the existing process-performance evidence.

10 • Equipment analyst: I will, with unknown matching status visible rather than concealed behind a favorable availability figure.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A maintained tool versus an unreviewed backup

Fictional scheduling review: tool A has completed preventive maintenance but awaits post-maintenance review; backup tool B is available but matching status is unknown.

01 • Scheduling lead: Tool A's maintenance is finished. Should we use it immediately instead of the available backup?

02 • Equipment engineer: Maintenance completion is recorded, but the post-maintenance review is pending. Availability alone doesn't establish readiness.

03 • Scheduling lead: Tool B is available now. Does its backup designation mean tool matching is already confirmed?

04 • Equipment engineer: Not in the records we have. Its matching status is unknown and needs owner confirmation.

05 • Scheduling lead: Then both choices have open conditions, although their reasons are different.

06 • Equipment engineer: Correct. Compare readiness evidence, scheduling availability, and product suitability on the same basis.

07 • Scheduling lead: Can we propose A subject to review while requesting B's matching record as an alternative?

08 • Equipment engineer: We can take those conditional options to the authorized planning owner without directing an unapproved run.

09 • Scheduling lead: I'll keep maintenance complete, readiness pending, and backup matching unknown as separate status entries.

10 • Equipment engineer: That makes the tradeoff transparent and avoids treating either tool as qualified by assumption.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Equipment Uptime, Recipes, and Tool Matching

Two tools run the same nominal recipe but show different measured results. A team member assumes their performance is interchangeable.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The recipe name is the same, but the observed results differ. Let's compare the controlled settings and qualification evidence before describing the tools as matched for this process.

Scenario 2 | Identical recipe names, different revisions

Two fictional tools display recipe name R7, but one record lists revision 2 and the other revision 3. Output comparison has not been performed. Discuss what must match before claiming interchangeability.

Role A: Equipment engineer: explain the identifier difference.

Role B: Production planner: ask for comparable configuration and performance evidence.

Possible opening: The displayed recipe names match, but their revision records differ, so interchangeability remains unconfirmed.

Success checks

- Separate recipe name from revision identity.
- Avoid treating newer as automatically qualified.
- Agree a records and performance review before allocation.

Add a complication: A colleague says the newer revision must be suitable for every tool.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

One reliability pass with two tests open

Fictional package review using the lesson case: one reliability test passed, two planned tests remain open, and a slide calls qualification complete.

01 • Customer quality lead: The slide says qualification complete. Have all planned package reliability tests actually finished?

02 • Package engineer: No. One test passed, while two remain open. The completion statement is too broad.

03 • Customer quality lead: Can we preserve the positive result without implying the remaining tests have passed?

04 • Package engineer: Yes. State which test passed and list the two pending tests under their current status.

05 • Customer quality lead: Does an open test mean a failure was found, or simply that its outcome isn't available?

06 • Package engineer: Here it means the planned work is still open; no outcome should be invented.

07 • Customer quality lead: Please also keep electrical binning results separate from the overall reliability qualification claim.

08 • Package engineer: Agreed. Classification by test results doesn't replace evidence for every planned reliability condition.

09 • Customer quality lead: I'll revise the customer wording and ask the qualification owner to confirm the next update.

10 • Package engineer: I'll provide the verified test status and avoid a completion date that hasn't been confirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A burn-in result is not every reliability result

Fictional device review: the recorded burn-in test passed, but the rest of the qualification matrix has not been reviewed in this meeting.

01 • Program manager: The burn-in report passed. Can I summarize that as all reliability requirements being satisfied?

02 • Test engineer: No. That report covers its specified test conditions, not the entire qualification matrix.

03 • Program manager: Could you explain the distinction for colleagues who see burn-in as a complete reliability guarantee?

04 • Test engineer: It is one defined stress-screening or test activity in this program, not proof about every future condition.

05 • Program manager: We haven't reviewed the other reports here, so their status remains unknown to this discussion.

06 • Test engineer: Correct. We should ask the qualification owner for the complete matrix instead of inferring completion.

07 • Program manager: Should I say the remaining tests are failures to prevent anyone assuming they passed?

08 • Test engineer: No. Unknown status is neither a pass nor a failure. Use the actual evidence boundary.

09 • Program manager: I'll report the burn-in result specifically and leave the overall qualification statement pending confirmation.

10 • Test engineer: I'll request the matrix and keep the package configuration attached to the evidence we discuss.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Different bins do not explain the cause

Fictional final-test review: a package lot has more units in a lower performance bin than a reference lot; test-condition comparability is unverified.

01 • Product engineer: More units entered the lower performance bin. Does that prove packaging damaged the devices?

02 • Test analyst: The binning distribution changed, but that observation alone doesn't establish the cause.

03 • Product engineer: What context do we need before interpreting the difference between these two lots?

04 • Test analyst: Comparable test conditions, product configuration, and bin definitions, plus the relevant lot history.

05 • Product engineer: Those checks are pending. I should not treat the lower bin as proof of a packaging defect.

06 • Test analyst: Correct. A bin records classification under the test criteria; attribution needs additional evidence.

07 • Product engineer: Can we still flag the distribution for the package and test teams to review jointly?

08 • Test analyst: Yes. Report the observed counts and preserve the unverified conditions as explicit questions.

09 • Product engineer: I'll avoid calling the lot unqualified solely from this comparison without the program's review.

10 • Test analyst: I'll bring the bin definitions and available records so the responsible team can assess the finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Packaging, Test, and Reliability Qualification

A package passes one reliability test while two planned tests remain open. A customer slide calls qualification complete.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: One test is complete; two are still open. I'll report the results by test and avoid describing the overall qualification as complete until the responsible team confirms the required evidence.

Scenario 2 | The report covers another package configuration

A fictional qualification report names package configuration P1. The proposed customer part uses P2. The relationship between configurations has not been reviewed. Discuss applicability without assuming either equivalence or failure.

Role A: Package engineer: identify the configuration mismatch.

Role B: Customer quality coordinator: ask who can review whether evidence applies.

Possible opening: The report covers P1; we still need an applicability review for the proposed P2 configuration.

Success checks

- Name the evidence boundary.
- Keep equivalence unconfirmed rather than claiming failure.
- Route applicability to the qualification owner.

Add a complication: A colleague says similar external dimensions prove equivalent qualification.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An earlier tape-out slot remains conditional

Fictional foundry negotiation using the lesson case: a customer requests an earlier tape-out slot, design checks are open, and capacity is limited.

01 • Customer program manager: Can the foundry move our tape-out earlier? The project team wants a firmer customer date.

02 • Foundry liaison: We can discuss options, but design checks remain open and capacity allocation is limited.

03 • Customer program manager: Could you reserve the earlier slot now and assume the checks will finish in time?

04 • Foundry liaison: I can't promise that. We need the design-readiness position and the foundry's actual allocation decision.

05 • Customer program manager: What can you offer today that helps us plan without creating a false commitment?

06 • Foundry liaison: I can request available options and state the readiness conditions attached to each proposal.

07 • Customer program manager: Please include the required process design kit, or PDK, version in that readiness discussion.

08 • Foundry liaison: Yes. The design team should confirm its check basis rather than assume versions are interchangeable.

09 • Customer program manager: I'll report the earlier date as requested, not secured, until those conditions and capacity are confirmed.

10 • Foundry liaison: I'll return with the foundry response and keep any unresolved checks explicit in the negotiation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A new PDK version before submission

Fictional design handoff: a team has checks against PDK version 6, while a proposed slot refers to version 7; applicability is unconfirmed.

01 • Design manager: Our checks passed against PDK six. Can we accept the proposed slot referring to PDK seven?

02 • Foundry interface engineer: First we need to confirm the applicable submission requirements and the effect of that version difference.

03 • Design manager: Could we simply rename the package so it matches the newer version in the slot note?

04 • Foundry interface engineer: No. A label change would not establish that the design was checked against the required basis.

05 • Design manager: Then what conditional proposal can we take back while preserving the current completed work?

06 • Foundry interface engineer: Ask whether the existing basis is acceptable or what reviewed updates are needed before submission.

07 • Design manager: I'll have the design-check owner assess that question without promising an immediate rerun completion.

08 • Foundry interface engineer: I'll clarify the foundry's slot conditions and whether timing alternatives are available.

09 • Design manager: Until then, our tape-out date remains provisional, with the version question clearly stated.

10 • Foundry interface engineer: Agreed. We'll negotiate from verified readiness and capacity information, not from a renamed file.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Splitting a request does not create capacity

Fictional capacity discussion: a customer proposes splitting one manufacturing request into two smaller requests; available foundry capacity has not been confirmed.

01 • Customer planner: Could we split our request into two smaller allocations and secure an earlier start that way?

02 • Foundry account lead: We can ask about phased allocation, but splitting the request doesn't itself create available capacity.

03 • Customer planner: I understand. The design team would still need to meet the same agreed readiness conditions.

04 • Foundry account lead: Yes, and the foundry must confirm whether the proposed phasing fits its actual planning constraints.

05 • Customer planner: Could you present the phased option alongside the original request without canceling the original proposal?

06 • Foundry account lead: I'll clarify how alternatives should be submitted so we don't unintentionally create duplicate commitments.

07 • Customer planner: What should I tell our internal team about timing while that discussion is ongoing?

08 • Foundry account lead: Say phased capacity is under discussion, with no earlier slot confirmed and readiness still subject to review.

09 • Customer planner: I'll keep both options conditional and ask the design owner for an updated check status.

10 • Foundry account lead: I'll bring back the capacity response so we can compare workable choices rather than assumed dates.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Foundry, Tape-Out, PDK, and Capacity Communication

A customer requests an earlier tape-out slot. Design checks are still open, and foundry capacity is limited.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: We can review the earlier slot, but the open design checks and capacity need confirmation. Could we agree on a decision point that reflects both readiness and the foundry's available schedule?

Scenario 2 | A slot offer expires before a readiness review

A fictional foundry offers a provisional slot with a response requested Thursday. The design-readiness review is Friday, and open checks remain. The liaison cannot approve capacity or waive checks. Negotiate a clarification or timing alternative.

Role A: Customer program manager: explain the mismatch and request an option.

Role B: Foundry liaison: offer to ask about an extension or later slot without guaranteeing either.

Possible opening: The requested response precedes our readiness review, so we cannot yet confirm that the design meets the slot conditions.

Success checks

- Keep open checks visible.
- Offer conditional alternatives within your authority.
- Agree who will confirm readiness and capacity separately.

Add a complication: The customer asks you to describe the open checks as administrative details.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Semiconductor English

Professional audience: semiconductor process engineers, yield engineers, product engineers, equipment engineers, fab supervisors, quality teams, test and packaging teams, foundry coordinators, supply planners, applications engineers, and technical program managers

Scope: These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Dialogue 01: Wafer-start priorities

Original fictional setting: A fab planning team reviews competing lot priorities.

Professional roles: Production planner / Fab operations lead

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Production planner: Two customer expedites need the same bottleneck tool. Which wafer starts are actually committed?

Fab operations lead: Check the confirmed allocation and downstream constraints before reprioritizing either lot.

Production planner: One request is an engineering split, not production demand.

Fab operations lead: Keep that distinction visible. Its process requirements may differ from the production flow.

Production planner: I'll compare cycle-time impact and the approved priority rules.

Fab operations lead: Bring the options to the scheduling review so the decision and affected commitments are documented.

Vocabulary in this exchange: wafer: Thin semiconductor substrate, usually silicon, on which integrated circuits are fabricated.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Semiconductor English

Professional audience: semiconductor process engineers, yield engineers, product engineers, equipment engineers, fab supervisors, quality teams, test and packaging teams, foundry coordinators, supply planners, applications engineers, and technical program managers

Scope: These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Dialogue 01: Wafer-start priorities

Original fictional setting: A fab planning team reviews competing lot priorities.

Professional roles: Production planner / Fab operations lead

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Production planner: Two customer expedites need the same bottleneck tool. Which wafer starts are actually committed?

Fab operations lead: Check the confirmed allocation and downstream constraints before reprioritizing either lot.

Production planner: One request is an engineering split, not production demand.

Fab operations lead: Keep that distinction visible. Its process requirements may differ from the production flow.

Production planner: I'll compare cycle-time impact and the approved priority rules.

Fab operations lead: Bring the options to the scheduling review so the decision and affected commitments are documented.

Vocabulary in this exchange: wafer: Thin semiconductor substrate, usually silicon, on which integrated circuits are fabricated.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level